Tools & External Resources

Your Weekly Tool

Student_Toolkit.xlsx — in this folder. Contains your Interview Log, Experiment Tracker, and KPI Dashboard. This is the ONE file you use every week.

Legal & Fundraising

YC SAFE Agreement (Simple Agreement for Future Equity)

https://www.ycombinator.com/documents The standard early-stage investment document. Used by thousands of startups. Free, open-source. Don’t let a lawyer charge you €5,000 to draft something worse.

Sequoia Capital — Writing a Business Plan

https://www.sequoiacap.com/article/writing-a-business-plan/ The industry-standard pitch deck structure. Problem → Solution → Why Now → Market → Competition → Product → Business Model → Team → Financials → Ask.

Building & Prototyping

Vercel + v0.dev

https://v0.dev Generate full frontend UIs from text descriptions. Best for landing pages and MVPs.

Replit

https://replit.com Build and deploy web apps from your browser. Free tier is enough for prototypes.

Claude / ChatGPT

For everything else — writing copy, analyzing interviews, generating code, brainstorming solutions. Use AI as your first employee.

Validation & PMF Measurement

Sean Ellis PMF Survey (Free Tool)

https://pmfsurvey.com Ready-made survey to measure product-market fit. Send to users, get your PMF score. The 40% “very disappointed” benchmark. No setup required.

Sequoia Arc PMF Framework (Free)

https://sequoiacap.com/article/pmf-framework/ Sequoia’s internal framework, now publicly available. Three archetypes of PMF. The best mental model for understanding where you are.

Fundraising Documents

EWOR Startup Templates (Free)

https://www.ewor.com/startup-templates Co-Founder Conversation Starter, OKR templates, Investor Update templates, Financial Model templates, Pitch Deck guidelines, Data Room templates. Excellent quality, free download.

Learning (Beyond the Reading List)

YC Startup School (Free)

https://www.startupschool.org 7-week free curriculum + 20+ hours of lectures. Pick the ones relevant to your current module.

TechStars Entrepreneur’s Toolkit (Free)

https://toolkit.techstars.com Modules on Lean Canvas, pitch, PMF (W3 framework), and founder mental health. Concise and practical.

First Round Review

https://review.firstround.com The best long-form articles on startup building. Searchable by topic. Start with their “Must Reads” collection.

a16z AI Canon

https://a16z.com/ai-canon/ Curated list of the most important AI papers, courses, and guides. Essential for AI-first founders.

Indie Hackers

https://www.indiehackers.com Real founders sharing real revenue numbers, strategies, and struggles. Good for staying grounded.